FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

TSX:MFI
www.mapleleaf.com

TSX:CBY
www.canadabread.ca

Contact: Lynda Kuhn
Vice-President, Public & Investor Relations
416-926-2026

MAPLE LEAF FOODS COMPLETES PURCHASE OF 4 MILLION COMMON SHARES FROM CANADA BREAD

Toronto, ON., January 30, 2003 . . . . Maple Leaf Foods Inc. and Canada Bread Company, Limited today announced the completion of the purchase by Maple Leaf Foods of four million common shares from Canada Bread at $26.50 per share in a private placement.

The financing offer, which was announced on December 10, 2002 was accepted by Canada Bread on January 9, 2003. The $26.50 price represented a 24% premium to the average closing price for Canada Bread common shares for the 10 days preceding the announcement and continues to represent a premium to Canada Bread's share price, which closed at $22.95 yesterday.

The Board of Directors of Canada Bread established a committee comprised of its directors who are independent of Maple Leaf Foods to consider the financing offer. The financing offer was unanimously approved by the Board of Directors of Canada Bread based on the recommendation of the independent directors.

Proceeds from the financing of $106 million will be used to pay down debt under the Company's existing credit facility with Maple Leaf Foods.

Prior to this transaction, Maple Leaf Foods beneficially owned 14,633,315 common shares representing approximately 68.3% of the outstanding common shares. Maple Leaf Foods now owns 18,633,315 common shares representing approximately 73.3% of the outstanding common shares.

Maple Leaf Foods Inc. is a leading Canadian food processing company committed to delivering quality food products to consumers around the world. Headquartered in Toronto, Canada, the Company employs more than 15,000 people at its operations across Canada and in the United States, Europe and Asia. Maple Leaf Foods had sales of $4.7 billion in 2001.

Canada Bread Company, Limited is a leading Canadian manufacturer of value-added flour-based products and fresh pasta to the retail and food service markets. Canada Bread maintains a national presence in the marketplace with four principal brand names: *Dempster's*^{TM}, *POM*^{TM}, *Oliveri*^{TM} and *Tenderflake*^{TM}.

NNNN